

EdX partners with The Linux Foundation to launch a free online course on Linux

EdX, the online learning initiative founded by Harvard and MIT, has announced a new partnership with The Linux Foundation, under which the course 'Introduction to Linux' will now be offered. This course on basic Linux training will be free to help students become better equipped to be among the hundreds of thousands professionals supporting the open source operating system. Previously offered as an online course for Rs 144,000, 'Introduction to Linux' will be The Linux Foundation's first free Massive Open Online Course (MOOC).

The Linux Foundation has long offered a wide variety of online training courses for the Linux operating system for a fee. This introductory class on edX.org, for Linux beginners and experts alike, will begin this summer and will be the first from The Linux Foundation to run as a MOOC. Nearly 90,000 people have registered to date, and with no cap on registration, many more are expected to enrol.

Jim Zemlin, the foundation's executive director, said: "Our mission is to advance Linux and that includes ensuring there is a talent pool of Linux professionals. To deepen that talent pool and give more people access to the best career opportunities in the IT industry, we are making our Linux training program more accessible to users worldwide." He added, "EdX shares our values in increasing access to course material that can help learners achieve their personal goals and advance important technologies like Linux. EdX, like the Linux Foundation, is not-for-profit and uses open source to innovate. Our partnership is a natural one, and we look forward to working together to bring important knowledge to the masses."

It's curtains for Dropbox competitor Ubuntu One

As Canonical goes all out to focus its efforts on its operating system, the first to be axed in the process is Dropbox competitor, Ubuntu One. Canonical has clearly stuck to the principle of survival of the fittest, also axing its streaming music service.

"If we offer a service, we want it to compete on a global scale. For Ubuntu One to continue to do that would require more investments than we are willing to make," CEO Jane Silber was quoted in a blog post. Storage and music are no longer available for purchase from the Ubuntu One Store now. While existing Ubuntu One customers can use the service until June 1, 2014, stored data will be available for download up to July 30. Meanwhile, annual subscribers will receive a pro-rated refund soon.

With the Ubuntu 14.04 LTS launch almost round the corner, Canonical will now focus on its popular operating system. Earlier, Canonical's Michael Hall revealed that future versions of Ubuntu will see a reversal of a key yet annoying feature introduced to desktop users in 2012. Upcoming Ubuntu versions will not show users Amazon product results in the Unity Dash, by default. On the downside, the change is not going to take effect in Ubuntu 14.04 LTS. The current version of Unity searches online sources upon receiving a user query in Dash; by default, it returns related results including product suggestions from Amazon alongside local files and apps. The feature can be turned off through a toggle in System Settings; however, it is annoying. The upcoming version of Unity will require users to 'opt-in' if they wish to see results from specific online sources like Amazon.

Google to launch Android TV

Google has been trying to enter the living room space for some time now. With the company's latest Android TV, there is a strong chance that it will soon crack the home doors open. As per reports, Android TV is the new Google endeavour, after Google TV, and the search engine has already started to work on developing apps for this platform.

According to reports, Android TV will be a major video content provider and Google has begun developing new applications for this TV platform. Google sources said, "Android TV is an entertainment interface, not a computing platform. It's all about finding and enjoying content with the least amount of friction."



Source code for Microsoft's MS-DOS and Word goes 'open'!

In a major development, Microsoft has yet again inched closer towards open source technology by donating the source code for its MS-DOS and Word for Windows programs. The source code of MS-DOS versions 1.1 (released in 1982) and 2.0 (released in 1983), as well as the code for Microsoft Word for Windows 1.1a (released in 1989) are now publicly available at the Computer History Museum in Mountain View, California. Anyone can now download the code from the museum's official website; however, it must be noted that the code is solely available for non-commercial use, subject to a licence agreement approval.

Microsoft achieved its iconic status of becoming a global organisation of 100,000+ employees and almost US\$ 43 billion in revenue (estimated as of December 2013) on the shoulders of aggressive software licensing practices. However, over the years, it has strived to ensure interoperability with open source projects – a drive that is clearly aimed at winning back some market share that it lost to a string of open source projects that are increasingly coming into the limelight.